

Contact

- 082 327 1104
- wehancoombs@gmail.com
- My website
- LinkedIn
- Pretoria East · in person or online

Qualifications

PhD in Philosophy
University of Pretoria, 2023

MA in Philosophy
UP, 2016, cum laude

BA Honours in Philosophy
UP, 2012, cum laude

BA Humanities: English Literature and Philosophy
UP, 2010

PGCE (FET Phase)
UP, in progress, 2026

TESOL/TEFL Certificate
120 hours, 2026

Languages

English
Home language

Afrikaans
Fluent

Dr Wehan M. Coombs

Teacher, philosopher, writer and learning designer

Profile

Philosopher and English teacher with a PhD, fifteen years of university teaching and a year in the high-school classroom. I explain difficult ideas clearly, design courses and materials from the ground up, write and edit with care, and build simple digital tools for learning. As much at home in front of five hundred first-years as in a seminar of six.

Skills

Teaching and facilitation
Lecturing to classes of 500; discussion seminars; Grade 10 to 12 English; online and hybrid teaching; one-to-one tutoring and TEFL.

Course design and tools
Four university modules built from scratch; five study guides and three readers; rubrics and assessments; ClickUP and Blackboard; live-streamed lectures; simple web apps.

Writing, editing and research
Two peer-reviewed articles and thirteen conference papers on Plato, Neoplatonism and esotericism; editing of theses, essays and course materials; digital PR copy.

Leading and organising
Tutor teams trained and managed; lecture schedules and assessment plans; student support systems; a colloquium co-organised.

Experience

University of Pretoria, Department of Philosophy
2010 – 2026

Tutor (2010 – 2013), Assistant Lecturer (2014 – 2018), Head Lecturer (2016 – 2026)

- Head lecturer for first-year, second-year and honours modules, including first-year classes of more than 500 students
- Designed four modules from scratch and partly redesigned a fifth, writing their study guides and co-compiling a custom reader
- Trained and managed tutor teams, created assessments, marked thousands of essays and exams, and taught live online with my own streaming equipment

University of Johannesburg
Apr 2024 – Apr 2026

Postdoctoral Research Fellow: Platonic and African Esotericism

Abbotts College Pretoria East and Hoërskool Garsfontein
May – Sep 2026

PGCE teaching practicums, ten weeks in charge of classes

- Grade 10 and 11 English Home Language and First Additional Language (*Macbeth*, *The Tempest*, poetry, film and grammar); mentor assessment 95/100, and 98/100 for an observed lesson

Freelance
2026 –

Tutoring, editing, learning design and digital PR writing for a marketing agency

Strengths

- Clear, patient explanation
- Close reading and argument
- Course and materials design
- Detailed, constructive feedback
- Online teaching and production
- Calm under a heavy workload
- Reliable deadlines

Memberships

Philosophical Society of Southern Africa (since 2017)

International Society for Neoplatonic Studies (since 2017)

SACE provisional registration as a student teacher (2026)

Full resume

Every module taught, every paper, the teaching portfolio and student evaluations. Scan or click:

Open the full resume online

Highlights

- Average student rating of **4.5 out of 5** across eight evaluated university courses, 2017 to 2026; **4.81** for the 2026 honours course
- **95/100** in the formal mentor assessment and **98/100** for an observed lesson during the 2026 school practicums
- Created **FIL110**, Introduction to Metaphysics and Epistemology, in 2019; still taught at the University of Pretoria in 2026
- Two articles in peer-reviewed journals and thirteen papers at conferences, colloquia and workshops since 2012

> *"In 2019 I noted that Dr Coombs had the potential to become a brilliant lecturer. In the years since, he has more than fulfilled that potential, at first-year, second-year and honours level, and I recommend him without reservation."*
>
> Prof Emma Ruttkamp-Bloem, Head of Philosophy, University of Pretoria, 2026

Publications and papers

- Coombs, W.M. 2017. Aristotle's harmony with Plato on separable and immortal soul. *South African Journal of Philosophy* 36(4): 541–552
- Coombs, W.M. 2013. Contingency, irony and morality: A critical review of Rorty's notion of the liberal utopia. *Humanities* 2(2): 313–327
- Is Philosophy A(gnostic)? Post-disciplinary Interventions in the Time of Metacrisis. PSSA Annual Conference, University of Cape Town, 2026 (with Mitchell Black)
- Reflexive Esotericism: Insights from Literary and Theological Hermeneutics. PSSA Conference, North-West University, 2025

Service and community

- Footnotes, the UP philosophy society, 2010 – 2025 (talks and film screenings); co-organised the Aristotle Colloquium at UP for Aristotle's 2400th birth year, 2016
- Community engagement at Abbotts College (community garden, a shoe donation outreach, Book Day) and Hoërskool Garsfontein (*Kersfees in die Winter*), 2026

Referees

Prof. Emma Ruttkamp-Bloem
Head of the Department of Philosophy, University of Pretoria
emma.ruttkamp-bloem@up.ac.za

Prof. John F. Finamore
Emeritus Professor of Classics, University of Iowa
john-finamore@uiowa.edu

Eben van Dien
Mentor teacher, Abbotts College Pretoria East
evdien@abbotts.co.za

Dr Mitchell Black
Colleague and research collaborator, University of Pretoria
mblackmitchell@gmail.com